them to me – I hit him for five sixes out of my total of seven. Then I cramped up and got caught behind by the mighty Kumara Sangakkara, but the Pakistan tail didn't hold up to the Lankan bowlers.

Against Bangladesh, something special happened. With my 53-ball century, we set up Pakistan's highest ODI total – 385/7 – beating another record I had been involved in establishing in Nairobi years ago – 371/4 against Sri Lanka in 1996 when I hit that 37-ball century. On the same day in 2010, I broke Sanath Jayasuriya's great record for ODI sixes.

But the politics in the dressing room never completely vanished. The captaincy crisis the team was going through since the late 2000s never really went away. Even winning the World T20 didn't bring us closer as a unit. The ups and downs of the dressing room were evident through our erratic, even inexplicable performances on the field. The batting collapses against Sri Lanka and India in the Asia Cup, all from seemingly comfortable positions, were a case in point.

There is a joke in Pakistan about the politics here.

It starts off with a guided tour of hell for a newly admitted sinner, who is being shown around his new digs by the devil. The sinner gets to one area, where there is a big cauldron of boiling oil, and in it is a man, whose head emerges every couple of minutes from the oil, screaming for help, only to be pushed back in by the devil. The sinner asks the devil what exactly is happening. The devil explains: this is a cauldron reserved for bankers; they took money from the poor and gave it to the rich, so they deserve to be in there.

Next, the sinner sees another cauldron, with the same punishment: a man whose head emerges out of the boiling oil, trying to get out, being pushed back in by the devil. The devil explains: this cauldron is reserved for lawyers; they took money from the rich to deprive the poor. They deserve to be in there.

Finally, the sinner comes to another cauldron of boiling oil, but nothing is happening with it. The oil is just boiling and bubbling on its own. The sinner asks the devil why there is no activity around this particular cauldron.

The devil responds: this cauldron is reserved for Pakistanis. I don't need to watch it. Every time a Pakistani tries to get out, another Pakistani below him pulls him back in.